

An ETABS model built from the drawings you already have

It removes the typing. It does none of the engineering.

Give it the plan DXFs drafting already exports and any ETABS file from the job. It returns a model with the geometry entered — walls at their true thicknesses on their centrelines, columns sized and turned as drawn, floor plates, headers over the openings, shafts and stairs cut out, pier labels so a wall reads as one element up the building.

1,119

wall panels

2,462

columns

82

floor plates

63

storeys

31168 YMCA Langara, from 62 plan sheets, all placed. None of it entered by hand.

WHAT YOU GIVE IT

1. The folder of plan DXFs drafting already exports for the job.

2. Any ETABS file from that job — even an empty shell with just the storeys. If you have a partial model, give it that.

No configuration. Nothing made specially.

Accuracy rides on two drafting-side things: layer discipline, and sheet titles matching the model's storey names.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

`...-FROM-DRAWINGS.e2k` — import it.

`...-report.txt` — location by location, why anything is missing.

`...-QUESTIONS.xlsx` — only what it could not decide. Four rows.

What it will not touch

No section properties, loads, stiffness modifiers, diaphragms or design — a diaphragm arriving with the geometry is one more thing to undo. And it never overwrites what you have already modelled: on 31138 it recognised 306 of your walls and 315 of your columns and left every one alone.

It gets better every time you tell it something

Every rule came from an engineer and can name the evidence behind it. Rules live in a database with a confidence level, and apply only once verified or confirmed by you.

Answer a question in the workbook

It becomes a rule at the highest confidence there is and applies to every model on every job from then on. You are asked once, ever.

Open a model and say what is wrong

It is measured against your models and the 400-odd on the share, then becomes a rule or a question with the measurement attached. Nothing changes on a hunch. Most recent: "the walls should not break at tower A elevations" — a member now spans its own tower's floor to ceiling in one piece, which took panels under 6 ft from 390 to 63 and columns from 921 to 4.

Ask for something it cannot do

That is where headers as spandrels, pier labels, cut openings and the basement wall came from. Each started as a sentence on a call.

It also learns without being asked: three of the five questions headed your way were answered by reading your own model instead — including that your 29 spandrels on 31138 imply an 88" opening where an 84" door had been assumed, which had made every header four inches too deep.

How far to trust it

Before it is sent, the model is checked against the drawings both ways — every drawn member must be modelled, and every modelled member must stand on linework from a sheet placed on its own storey. Size and shape are checked against the raw drawing entities, and every check is proved against the defect it exists for. **What it does not know, it says:** on 31168, 7 of its 3,435 drawn members unaccounted for, six storeys whose slab edges will not close, one roof plate with nothing beneath it, and four questions.

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